

Sakina Ghafoor

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EDUCATION

Texas Christian University

College of Science & Engineering

Fort Worth, Texas

Experimental Psychology PhD

Texas Christian University

College of Science & Engineering

Fort Worth, Texas

Experimental Psychology MS

Texas Christian University

May 2025

College of Science & Engineering

Fort Worth, Texas

Psychology BS, Data Science Minor

EXPERIENCE

Texas Christian University

May 2025 - Present

Institute of Behavioral Research, Graduate Research Assistant

Texas Christian University

Aug 2024 - Apr 2025

Institute of Behavioral Research, Undergraduate Research Assistant and Referral Coordinator

Undergraduate Advanced Internship, Tier 3

- Increasing Access to PrEP for Minority Women by Leveraging Beauty Shops as Community Health Hubs and Mobile Healthcare
- Coordinated referrals, developed guides for community resources, and managed REDCap database management system to collect data and clinical information.

JPMorgan Chase

Jun 2024 - Aug 2024

Technology Audit, Summer Analyst Intern

- EPIX (Engineer Platform & Experience) Team
- Focusing on reviews of business applications, data management, global infrastructure, digital technologies, and cyber/information security. Evaluating the effectiveness of controls for the EPIX (Engineer Platform & Experience) team looking at technology development. Providing management with feedback regarding the control environment.

Texas Christian University

Jun 2023 - May 2024

Institute of Behavioral Research, Undergraduate Research Assistant

Undergraduate Apprenticeship, Tier 2

- Increasing Access to PrEP for Minority Women by Leveraging Beauty Shops as Community Health Hubs and Mobile Healthcare
 - Collaborated with research staff to assist with data-collection protocols for Mobile Health Unit health services including cancer screenings, access to contraceptives/PrEP, mental health, social support, and STI testing. Built out the study data collection tool and electronic-medical record system for use on the mobile clinic and in the field using the REDCap database management system
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Eduplanner.ai

Aug 2023 - Feb 2024

Research & Data Analysis Intern

- Worked with a startup team in a scientific study on the effects of a novel AI planning software on education outcomes and contributed to a well-structured report that helps inform future decisions. Helped recruit volunteers from a sample of college students and collected high-quality, relevant data. Insightfully analyzed data and contributed to research findings.

RESEARCH**Texas Christian University**

Aug 2024 - Apr 2025

Institute of Behavioral Research SOAR Lab, Undergraduate Student Researcher

- Attitudes Toward Narcan
- What do people know about Narcan? If we give Narcan to people will they use it? Give it to others?

Texas Christian University

Aug 2024 - Dec 2024

Institute of Behavioral Research, Undergraduate Student Researcher

- NEMSIS EMS Exploratory Project
- Utilized various data analysis and machine learning techniques to find patterns in data regarding opioid overdoses and narcan administration.

Texas Christian University

May 2023 - May 2024

Institute of Behavioral Research SOAR Lab, Undergraduate Student Researcher

- Testing a Brief Mindfulness Intervention
- Reviewed measures and data collection/analysis procedures.

Texas Christian University

Oct 2022 - May 2023

Institute of Behavioral Research SOAR Lab, Undergraduate Student Researcher

- Developing a Measure of Criminal Thinking for the General Population
- Gather data to test the measure using a sample population, test the survey for validity, and create normative scores. Recruited participants and collected data through TCU's SONA System.

PUBLICATIONS

Villaire, S., Hastings, S., Johnson, M., Reid, Q., **Ghafoor, S.**, Carey, P. D., Proffitt, R. P., & Knight, K. (2026). Bridging beauty and wellness: Examining beauty professionals' comfort in discussing sexual health. *Frontiers in Reproductive Health*, 7, Article 1688125. <https://doi.org/10.3389/frph.2025.1688125>

Sease, T. B., Weise, A. L., **Ghafoor, S.**, & Knight, K. (under review). *Development and Preliminary Testing of a Criminal Thinking Measure for the General Population*.

PRESENTATIONS

Ha, J., Ibe, C., Johnson, L., Rishel, K., Borne, B., Estes, B., Farah, V., Miguel, K., Ocampo, G., Reyes, S., Soto, I., Olabisi, E., **Ghafoor, S.**, Sease, A., & Knight, K. (2026, April). *Amen and Awareness: A Fort Worth Faith Community Study on HIV Prevention*. Poster Presentation at the TCU Louise Dilworth Davis CSE 23rd Annual Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Castillo, R., Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2026, March). *A Machine Learning Approach to Patient Perceptions of AI in Clinical Encounters*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Psychological Association 2026 Annual Conference, Frisco, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Castillo, R., Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2025, October). *Hostility as a Prospective Mediator of the Relationship Between Treatment Engagement and Decision Making for People in Court-Mandated Substance Use Treatment*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Association of Criminal Justice 2025 Annual Conference, Fort Worth, Texas.

Castillo, R., **Ghafoor, S.,** Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2025, October). *Leveraging AI to Uncover Strengths: A Qualitative Study on Reintegration Success for Justice-Involved Individuals*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Association of Criminal Justice 2025 Annual Conference, Fort Worth, Texas.

Villaire, S., Reid, Q., **Ghafoor, S.,** Hastings, S., Carey, P., Proffitt, R., & Knight, K. (2025, April). *Increasing PrEP Access for Black Women: The Role of Beauty Professionals in HIV Prevention Education*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., DeMattia, M., Wrucke, M., Blakeney, B., Reimer, C., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2024, April). *Testing the Feasibility and Engagement of a Brief Mindfulness Intervention for Nursing Students*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Sease, T. B., **Ghafoor, S.,** & Cox, C. (2024, February). *State of Surrender: A Novel & Distinct Correlate of Psychological Well-Being*. Poster accepted to the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Conference, San Diego CA.

Ghafoor, S., Rippey, L., Bliss, L., Gomez, J., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2023, April). *Developing a Measure of Criminal Thinking for the General Population*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Rippey, L., Bliss, L., Gomez, J., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2023, April). *Developing a Measure of Criminal Thinking for the General Population*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University, Impact of Health and Justice Research on Policy and Practice Conference for the 60th Anniversary of the Institute of Behavioral Research, Fort Worth, Texas.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Tools & Technologies

- Java, JavaScript, Python, Linux, C, Scala, C Language Integrated Production System (CLIPS), R
- Microsoft Office, Eclipse IDE, VS Code, Google Colab/Jupyter, Jamovi
- TCU SONA System, Qualtrics, PowerBI, ATLAS.ti, REDCap

Core Competencies

- Data Visualization, Computer Literacy, Database Management, Technology Development Management
- Effective Communication, Report Writing, Organization, Analytical, Personable, Detail Oriented

Responsible Conduct in Research Compliance Training

- Texas Christian University, Office of Research

Issued Aug 2025

● Expire: after 4 years	
Information Privacy Security: Health Privacy (HIPAA) ● CITI Program, ID: 70908698	Issued Jul 2025
Internal Audit Analyst Virtual Experience Program ● Forage	Issued Aug 2023
Machine Learning with Python ● freeCodeCamp	Issued Aug 2023
Data Analysis with Python ● freeCodeCamp	Issued Jul 2023
Java (Basic) ● HackerRank, ID: F5AD52C5EF39	Issued Jul 2023
Initial Biosafety Training ● CITI Program, ID: 56502601 ● Expire: Jun 2027	Issued Jun 2023
OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens ● CITI Program, ID: 56502602 ● Expire: Jun 2027	Issued Jun 2023
Conflict of Interest ● CITI Program, ID: 52026855 ● Expire: Oct 2026	Issued Oct 2022
Human Subjects Research ● CITI Program, ID: 52026856 ● Expire: Oct 2026	Issued Oct 2022
PROFESSIONAL ENGAGEMENTS & MEMBERSHIPS	
Institute of Behavioral Research, SOAR Lab ● Student Overview of Applied Research (SOAR) ● Student Mentor	Aug 2025 - Present
Institute of Behavioral Research, SOAR Lab ● Student Overview of Applied Research (SOAR) ● Undergraduate Lab Student	Oct 2022 - May 2025
helloFinance Virtual Summer Series ● Selected Participant	Jul 2023 - Aug 2023
Robotics and Artificial Intelligence Club	Oct 2022 - May 2025

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- Member

SCHOLARSHIPS & HONORS

Dec 2022	Dean's Honor List, Dean Kruger and The College of Science & Engineering
2021-2025	Dean's Scholarship, Texas Christian University

REFERENCES

Randi P. Proffitt, Ph.D.

Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University
Associate Graduate Faculty, College of Science & Engineering, Texas Christian University
Assistant Professor of Medical Education, TCU Burnett School of Medicine

Thomas Sease, Ph.D.

Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University

Pamela Carey, D.P.A.

Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University
